Yifei Zhu

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Politics and Public Administration, The University of Hong Kong

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EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong — Hong Kong
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science; expected completion: 2027 — Sep 2023 – Present

China Agricultural University — Beijing, China
A.M., Social Policy — Sep 2020 – Jun 2023

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics — Shanghai, China
LL.B., Law — Sep 2016 – Jun 2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Methodological: Large language models and AI agents; machine learning and natural language processing; causal inference and experimental methods; social network analysis.

Substantive: AI for social science; Chinese politics; political elites; elite networks.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Yifei Zhu**. "PolitNuggets: Benchmarking Agentic Discovery of Long-Tail Political Facts." Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, 2026. arXiv. Dataset.
- Lai Wei and **Yifei Zhu**. "Using AI Predictions to Augment Rather Than Replace Surveys." Accepted, Sociological Science.
- Leizhen Zang, **Yifei Zhu**, and Antoine Roth. "Mobilizing the State Without Crushing Local Knowledge: Evidence From China's Poverty-Alleviation Campaign." Public Administration and Development, 2026. DOI.
- Leizhen Zang, **Yifei Zhu**, and Di Cheng. "Inequality through Digitalization: Investigation of Mediating and Moderating Mechanisms." Information Technology for Development 31(4), 2025, 821–836. DOI.

WORKING PAPERS

- **Yifei Zhu**, Songpo Yang, Jiangnan Zhu, and Junyan Jiang. "Agentic Framework for Political Biography Extraction." Revise and resubmit (Research Note), American Journal of Political Science. arXiv. Code.
- **Yifei Zhu**, Jingtian Hu, Yinzhi Lin, Zhenhua Tu, and Xun Pang. "Evaluating Silicon Subjects for Foreign-Policy Experiments." Working paper.
- **Yifei Zhu** and Jiangnan Zhu. "Diverging Careers in Authoritarian Oversight: CCDI Membership and Elite Promotion in China." Working paper, 2026.
- Junqi Feng, Sidi Huang, Jiangnan Zhu, and **Yifei Zhu**. "Party Organizer: The Selection Pattern of POD Heads from 1949–2025." Working paper, 2026.

BOOKS AND BOOK CHAPTERS

- Chapter contributor. LLM reasoning and agents, for the planned Chinese-language volume Large Language Models for Social Science.

CONFERENCE PAPERS, PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

- January 8, 2027. Asian Political Methodology Meeting (Asian PolMeth), The University of Hong Kong. Poster presentation (scheduled).
- November 18, 2026. The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology. Scheduled talk on frontiers in LLM simulation for social science.
- September 2026. APSA Annual Meeting, Global Forum, Boston. "Party Organizers: Provincial Organizational Department Heads from 1949 to 2025." Coauthored with Jiangnan Zhu.
- September 2026. University of Rhode Island, Department of Political Science. Guest talk: "Agentic Framework for Political Biography Extraction."
- July 2026. The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics, San Diego. "PolitNuggets: Benchmarking Agentic Discovery of Long-Tail Political Facts."
- May 2026. Yale FDS Workshop: AI for Social Science Research Methods, Yale University. "Using AI Predictions to Augment Rather Than Replace Surveys." With Lai Wei. Poster.
- January 2026. New Horizons for AI Research in the Social Sciences and Humanities Conference, University of Chicago Hong Kong Campus.
- September 2025. APSA Annual Meeting, Vancouver. "Agentic Framework for Political Biography Extraction."
- May 2025. Fudan-UCSD Young Talented Scholars Conference, San Diego. "Agentic Framework for Political Biography Extraction."
- September 2024. APSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia. "Power Incubator: How An Authoritarian Anticorruption Agency Facilitates Power Sharing?"
- April 2024. Hong Kong Quantitative Social Science Workshop, Hong Kong. "Power Incubator: How An Authoritarian Anticorruption Agency Facilitates Power Sharing?"
- November 2022. Lien Development Conference, Singapore.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE AND INTERESTS

- Guest Lecturer, short course on LLMs and agents, The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Dec 2025.
- Guest Lecturer, short course on LLMs and agents, Peking University, Jul 2025.
- Guest Lecturer, short course on LLM for Data Analysis, The University of Hong Kong, May 2025.
- Teaching Assistant, CCCH9010: Understanding China's Governance: Challenges and Prospects, The University of Hong Kong.
- Teaching Assistant, SINO1003: Greater China: A Multi-disciplinary Introduction, The University of Hong Kong.
- Teaching interests: Political Methodology; Data Science for Political Science; Chinese Politics; Language Models for Social Science.

AWARDS AND RESEARCH SUPPORT

- Postgraduate Scholarship (PGS), The University of Hong Kong.
- Research grant for language modeling, Tsinghua University, 2026 (US$3,000).

SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITY

- Reviewer, NeurIPS.

SOFTWARE AND LANGUAGES

Software: Python, R, Stata, Codex, Claude Code, pi.

Languages: Chinese (native); English (fluent).

REFERENCES

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Assistant Professor of Political Science
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